ROSIE THE RIVETERS AWARDED CONGRESSIONAL GOLD MEDAL 79 YEARS AFTER THE END OF WW 2

THE WOMEN OF WW2 WERE AWARDED WITH OUR NATION'S HIGHEST CIVILIAN HONOR

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"These are the invisible warriors on the home front," House Speaker Mike Johnson said Wednesday at the medal ceremony, held at the U.S. Capitol.

abc NEWS

April 10, 2024

The women who became known as *"Rosie the Riveters"* for their work in helping to lead the United States to victory during World War II were honored Wednesday with a *Congressional Gold Medal.*

"These are the women who built our bombs," House Speaker Mike Johnson said Wednesday at the medal ceremony, held at the U.S. Capitol. "These are the invisible warriors on the home front."

"Rosie the Riveter" was the moniker given to women who went to work during World War II, taking on roles historically dominated by men while men were drafted to fight overseas.

Around 5 million civilian women went to work during the war, many helping to build equipment for the war, while around 350,000 American women served in the military, according to the U.S. Department of Defense.



Jeanne Gibson (C), a so-called 'Rosie the Riveter,' prepares for a Congressional Gold Medal ceremony honoring her service, along with twenty-seven other Rosies, in the US Capitol, in Washington, D.C., on April 10, 2024. Decades after their work, the "Rosie the Riveters" were collectively awarded Wednesday with Congress's highest civilian honor.

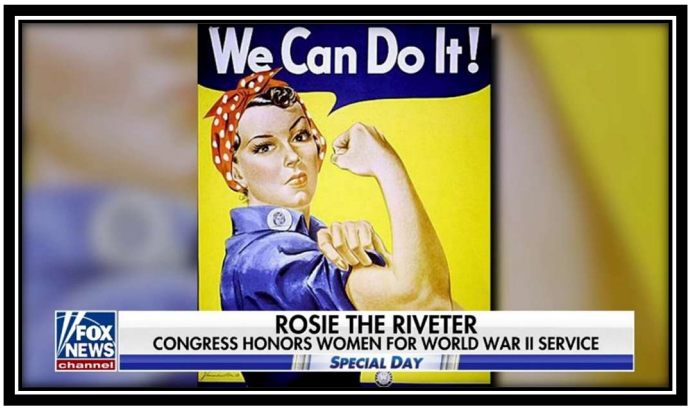


Sylvia "Delsi" Tanis, 98 years old, an original member of the "Rosies" poses for a portrait prior to a Congressional Gold Medal Ceremony honoring the "Rosies" - women such as 'Rosie the Riveter' who held jobs or volunteered in support of the war effort during World War II

"This recognition is long overdue, but today Congress finally bestows this honor on these deserving patriots," said Republican Sen. Susan Collins, of Maine, a cosponsor of The Rosie the Riveter Congressional Gold Medal Act, legislation that was *passed in 2020* and led to the women receiving the medal Wednesday.



Twenty-eight so-called 'Rosie the Riveters,' women who entered the US defense workforce during WWII, pose for a group photo ahead of a Congressional Gold Medal ceremony honoring their service in the US Capitol, in Washington, D.C., April 10, 2024.



One of the dozens of original "Rosie the Riveters" who traveled to Washington, D.C., to receive the medal in person was Lucille "Cille" MacDonald, a 98-year-old who lives in Hawaii.

When the war broke out, MacDonald, then a 17-year-old, left her family's farm in South Carolina and hopped on a Greyhound bus to Georgia to help.

MacDonald told ABC News that she was "scared to death" when Japan dropped a bomb on Pearl Harbor on Dec. 7, 1941. "That's when I said, 'Do something about it. Just do something about it. Stop worrying and do something about it,'" MacDonald recalled. "So I became very patriotic and very much in love with my country."

MacDonald became a journeyman welder in Brunswick, Georgia.

"I was the best welder in the entire shipyard," she recalled. "I can't forget that. I can't ever forget that. The best, and boy that's saying a lot. And I launched one huge ship a week. In just a week. I mean, imagine. You know how big a ship is? A ship is huge."



Lucille “Cille” MacDonald

NOTE

Unfortunately, Lucille “Cille ” MacDonald, a Maui resident who was recognized by Congress on April 10, 2024 for her work building ships during World War II died Friday just weeks short of what would have been her 99th birthday, Nov 20, 2024

Another woman honored Wednesday was Mae Krier, a Levittown, Pennsylvania, resident who built B-17 and B-29 bombers in Seattle from 1943 to 1945. Years later, at the start of the coronavirus pandemic in 2020, Krier, 94 years old at the time, began making face masks in the same red polka dot fabric worn in the famed "Rosie the Riveter" poster.

She was credited Wednesday for being an "unrelenting advocate" in making sure the women of her generation received their due.



Krier, dressed in a red polka dot vest, accepted the Congressional Gold Medal on behalf of all the Rosies, calling it a "great honor."

"Up until 1941, it was a man's world. They didn't know how capable us women were, did they," Krier said to loud applause, later adding that she is most proud of the path she and other women set for future generations.

"We're so proud of the women and young girls who are following in our lead," she said. "I think that's one of the greatest things we left behind is what we've done for women."

Krier ended her remarks with the words that came to symbolize the motto of "Rosie the Riveters," saying, "We can do it."



TRIBUTES TO ALL "ROSIE THE REVITERS"

NORMAN ROCKWELL'S ORIGINAL PICTURE



The original Rosie the Riveter painting by Norman Rockwell is in the permanent collection of ***the Crystal Bridges Museum of American Art in Bentonville, Arkansas:***

The painting was acquired by the museum in 2009 from a private collector after it was auctioned by Sotheby's in 2002 for nearly $5 million. The painting is one of the most popular works in the museum's galleries.

Here are some details about the painting:

It's 52 x 40 inches and is on canvas.

It depicts Rosie wearing men's work clothes, holding a riveter, and eating lunch with a copy of Hitler's manifesto, *Mein Kampf* under her foot.

The painting's pose and muscularity were inspired by a Renaissance artwork.

It features a white "V for Victory" button, a Blue Star Mothers pin, an Army-Navy E Service production award pin, and two bronze civilian service awards.

The model for Rosie was Mary Doyle Keefe, a 19-year-old telephone operator.

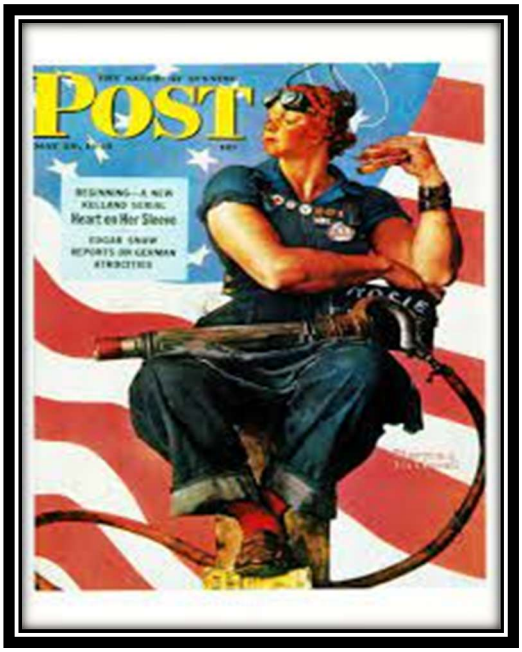
The painting is a powerful symbol of women's empowerment during World War II.

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